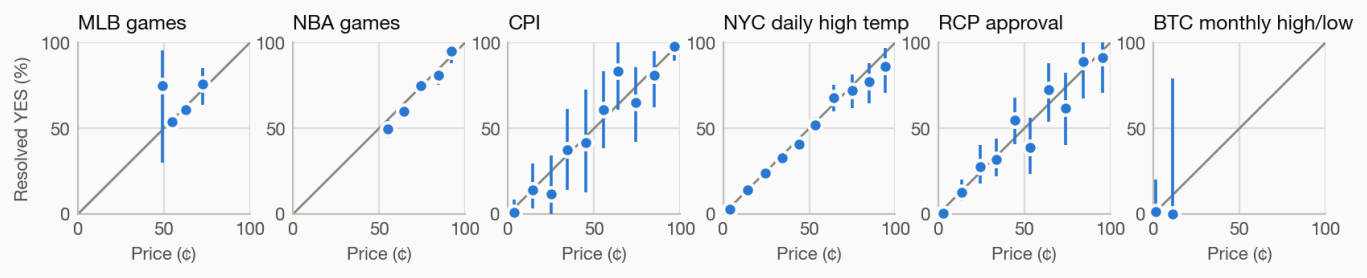
Are Kalshi prices calibrated? Six categories, 24 hours before close

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Bottom line. Across 12,345 settled markets in sports, economics, weather, politics and crypto, Kalshi prices 24 hours before close track outcomes closely: in 39 of 41 ten-cent price bins, the average price falls inside the 95% interval of the share that resolved YES. The two exceptions shrink under scrutiny: NBA favorites' gap is mostly the overround, and high-priced NYC temperature contracts' gap disappears once stale prices are removed.



Each point is a 10¢ price bin (x = average price, y = share resolved YES) with its 95% interval; gray line = perfect calibration. Sports panels show each game's favorite.

Group	Analyzed	Avg price	Resolved YES (95% CI)	Gap (pts)	Brier (reference)
MLB games	favorite side of 2,529 games	57.0¢	55.9% (54.0–57.8%)	−1.1	0.2441 (0.2465)
NBA games	favorite side of 1,498 games	69.4¢	66.4% (63.9–68.7%)	−3.0	0.2058 (0.2233)
CPI	423 markets in 64 events	50.7¢	50.1% (38.2–62.0%)	−0.6	0.0787 (0.2500)
NYC daily high temp	6,748 markets in 1,778 events	23.9¢	22.7% (20.8–24.7%)	−1.2	0.1387 (0.1756)
RCP approval	1,019 markets in 211 events	18.8¢	17.7% (13.1–23.4%)	−1.2	0.0869 (0.1454)
BTC monthly high/low	128 markets in 18 events	1.4¢	1.6% (0.0–20.1%)	+0.2	0.0146 (0.0154)

Method. Kalshi public API, seven series, markets settled 2021 to October 2026. Price = last trade at or before 24h before close; markets with under 1,000 contracts of lifetime volume excluded. Two-team sports use each game's favorite only, because the two sides are mirror bets. Other series use every market, with intervals from resampling whole events, because markets within an event are linked. Reference Brier = always predicting the group's overall YES rate.

Findings

1. **NBA favorites' gap is mostly the overround.** Favorites priced at 69.4¢ won 66.4% (CI 63.9–68.7%). But the two sides of an NBA game summed to 101.78¢ on average; net of that, the favorite's price is 68.2¢, inside the interval. Favorites priced 50–69¢ still sit below the line, even after removing stale prices (−6.4 and −4.6 points), so that range is worth a closer look.
2. **The largest gap is a stale-price effect.** NYC temperature contracts at 80¢ or more resolved YES 7.9 points less often than priced (88.5¢ vs 80.6%). Dropping prices that were more than 3h stale or outside the bid-ask flips the 80–89¢ and 90–99¢ bins from −7.6 and −8.2 to +1.8 and +2.0.
3. **Longshots ran slightly rich, but not significantly.** Contracts under 20¢ resolved YES less often than priced in CPI (5.9¢ vs 3.8%), NYC temperature (7.2¢ vs 6.5%) and RCP approval (5.1¢ vs 3.2%). The direction is consistent, but every interval contains the price.

Limitations

- One horizon (24h). MLB markets closing in 2025 opened a median of 14h before close, so the MLB sample is mostly the 2026 season.
- Crypto is thin: the typical Kalshi BTC market lives about an hour. The monthly high/low series give 128 markets in 18 events, all priced under 20¢.
- Prices are last trades, which include the bid-ask spread but not fees. Brier scores reflect how settled outcomes are a day out, so they don't rank categories.
- With 41 bins at 95% confidence, about two misses are expected by chance alone.